



Hotel Figueroa Brand Guidelines

To relate to artists, we must be artists.

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*Hotel
Figueroa*
DOWNTOWN
LOS ANGELES

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Brand Platform: Pillars

Safety	We are a safe place to stay, a safe place to work, a safe place to play, a safe place to be creative, and a safe place to choose any level of participation you wish. This is a safe place to be you. Our origin story supports this Pillar, and is our...
Inspiration	We inspire creativity by maintaining an environment of learning and tolerance, always striving to create beauty, and engaging every sense in harmony. To Inspire we live the art, through...
Collaboration	We are partners in creating this moment in the life of our guest and to create the moment, we collaborate with artisans to create curated experiences in everything we do. And it's not the same experience over and over, because we thrive on....
Education	We don't just do or show art, we teach it and learn it at every opportunity. And we remember there is art in everything around us, we are...
Immersive	We're involved, you should be too, and while we lift YOU up, we always project...
Humility	We are forever honored to be a part of this amazing downtown community and surrounded by such awe inspiring and creative people.

Brand Platform: Mission statement

PROMISE: We are an ever-changing canvas of creation and authentic Downtown Los Angeles experiences.

MISSION: We are the evangelists for Downtown Los Angeles and the creativity that it inspires.

VISION: To relate to artists, we must be artists.

VALUES

We are sincere, but playful enough not to take ourselves too seriously

We are excited about life and share that excitement

We are competent and highly effective

We are sophisticated, glamorous and charming, but never pretentious

We are creative collaborators always open to inviting participation

We are caring and sharing with our planet and all of its inhabitants

We are authentic Los Angeles, not contrived

WHO WE ARE

We are Heritage - 1925

We are Vintage/Original

We are Rebirth

We are DTLA

We are collaborators

We are authentic

WHAT WE ARE NOT

We are NOT imported

We are NOT out-of-towners

We are NOT pretentious

We are NOT big box

We are NOT predictable



Brand Platform: Voice

DTLA

We are Downtown Los Angeles, we are not a New York brand coming to play in Los Angeles or a faceless chain hotel. We are an authentic downtown brand that isn't being taken over, it's being reborn to its original glory. We will welcome people to our town and be the emissaries of DTLA.

ARTISANS

Creative People are attracted to other creative people and especially to artisans. To attract artisans we must be artisans. This should be a defining factor whenever we add any art/music/creative to the hotel, we don't want the art, we want the artist. To attract the creative market we must forge solid relationships with great artists.

We are a luxury hotel for creative minded people.

Brand Platform: Creative Philosophy

To relate to artists, we must be artists.
So, let's start thinking like an artist.

Logo Philosophy

What is one thing all great works of art have in common?

They sign their work;

A restaurant's "signature" dish

The makers mark on a sculpture

The signature on a painting

Personalization

A representation of who they are

So what does that really mean?

I did this and I stand behind my work.

With that in mind we are going to use our logo to sign our work.



Hotel Figueroa logo: Overview

The Hotel Figueroa “Signature Logo” is the embodiment of our brand message - We sign our work.

Hotel Figueroa Signature logo

Signature logo

The Signature logo should be used for three main purposes:

1. As the primary logo used in all visual identity
2. For all internal and external printed collateral
3. For all partner placements printer or electronic



Standard logo: Specifications

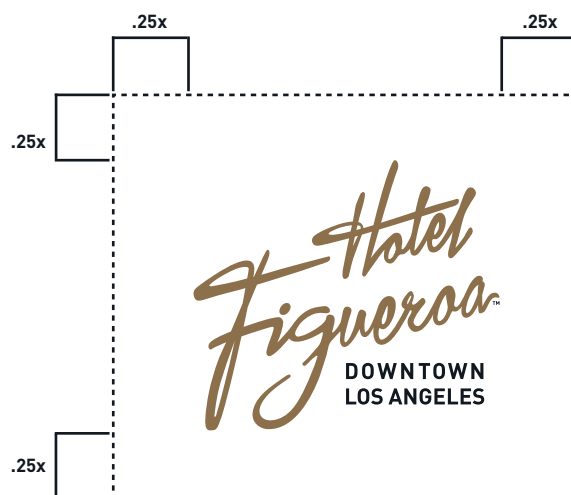
The Signature logo should be used for three main purposes:

- 1) As the primary logo used in all visual identity
- 2) For all internal and external printed collateral
- 3) For all partner placements printed or electronic

Color

The primary Hotel Figueroa Signature logo is the 2-color version - **Metallic Pantone 874 C + Pantone Black 6 C**. When color or printing prohibits this, it may be used in all black or reversed out to white. The registration mark should be black or white to match the “Downtown Los Angeles” typography.

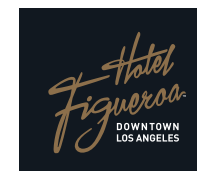
Clear space & minimum size



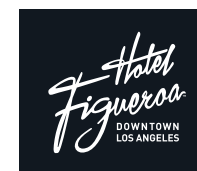
Minimum size



2-color



1-color



Logo: Color Specifications

The Signature logo is designed to use foil or metallic ink whenever printed.

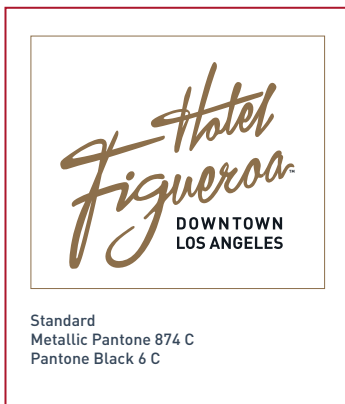
There are a number of acceptable color variations for limitations of printing and electronic media, as shown below.

The primary version of the logo in printed materials is - **Metallic Pantone 874 C + Pantone Black 6 C**

Primary Versions of logo



Solid
Metallic Pantone 874 C



Standard
Metallic Pantone 874 C
Pantone Black 6 C



Over Black
Metallic Pantone 874 C
White



Over White
Pantone Black 6 C
or
100% Black / #000000



Over Black
100% White / #ffffff

Logo: Color Specifications (red)

The Signature logo can be used in red when it is helpful to separate it from a background image. It should not ever be used in red over white or in any collateral pieces.

Primary Versions of logo



Pantone 187 C
Used to highlight red that is present in the imagery and to add clarity



Pantone 187 C + Pantone Black 6 C
Best used over light colored background images where the black type will stand out better than white or red text.



Pantone 187 C + Pantone Black 6 C
Best used over light colored background images where the white type will stand out better than black or red text.



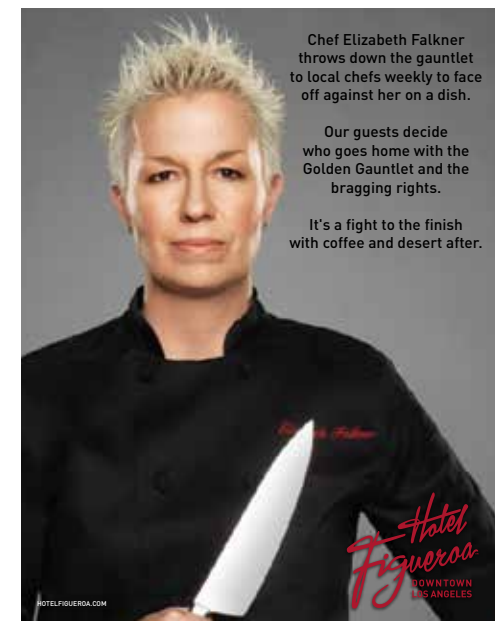
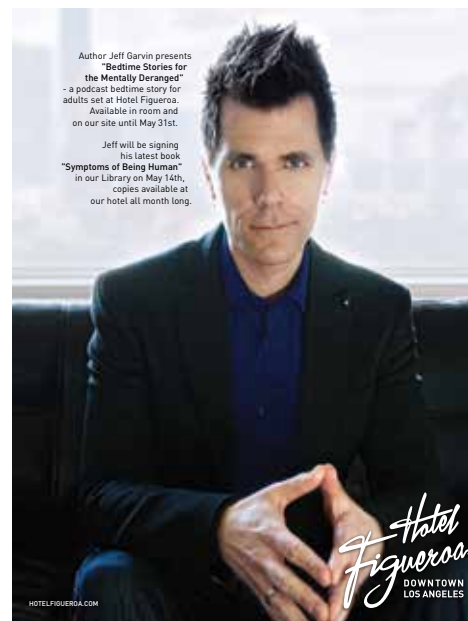
Do not use the solid red signature logo on white or in a situations where the standard logo can be used.

Usage examples: Printed communications

Collaboration Ads: These ads embody collaboration most directly, showing the artists we are working with. We express humility by talking about artists and not ourselves. We also prepare our guest for an immersive experience that will both educate and inspire.

These examples have three fundamental components.

1. Arresting image of artist
2. Copy block that tells a compelling story that ends with a call to action
3. Master logo in bottom right that symbolizes a signed piece of art



Usage examples: Printed communications, cont.

Architectural Ads: These ads will be limited to architectural or other relevant publications and also work as single sales sheets. The idea is simply to show off our creation and sign our work. We want to tend toward humility and talking about others, but for the occasions we must show a room this is how we do it.

These examples have three fundamental components.

1. Stunning property image that highlights differentiating factors of the interior design
2. Optional copy or tag-line
3. Master logo in bottom right that symbolizes a signed piece of art



Usage examples: Printed communications, cont.

Pre-launch Ads: These ads are meant to convey creation in progress, they will in some cases show hints of what is to come, and in others just hint towards a coming soon. We will remain with the nomenclature of Open Summer 2016 until we get a firm date.

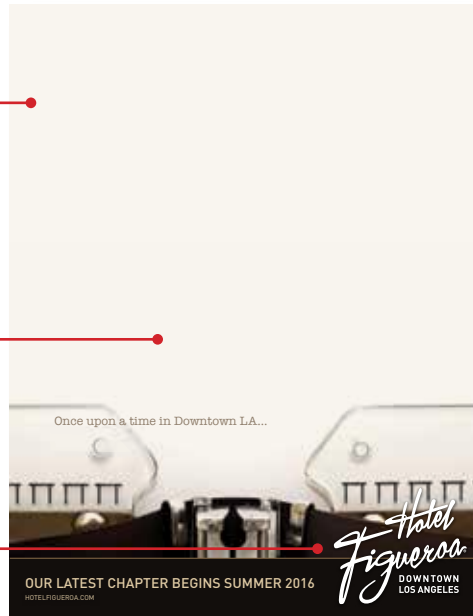
These examples have three fundamental components.

1. Thought provoking images designed for very specific targeted markets that hint at what's to come
2. Teaser copy written in the vernacular of the target market
3. Master logo in bottom right that symbolizes a signed piece of art

1

2

3



Usage examples: Online communications - Collaboration Ads

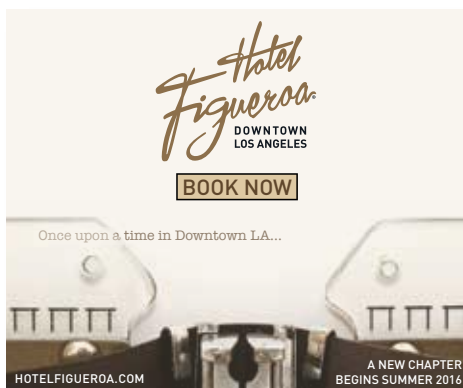
Online Ads will follow the print formats of collaboration, architectural, and pre-launch.

These examples have four fundamental components.

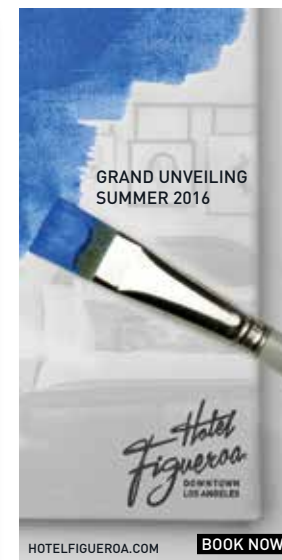
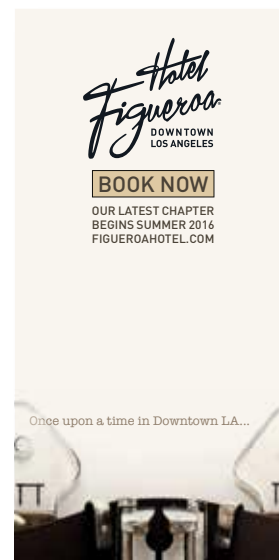
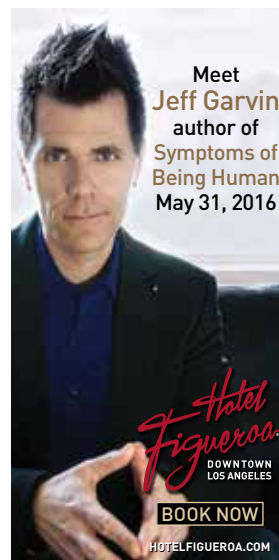
1. Arresting image of artist shot to fit the deliverable
2. Copy block that promotes an event or opportunity
3. Master logo in bottom right that symbolizes a signed piece of art
4. Book Now button with URL where size is appropriate



Usage examples: Online communications - Collaboration ads cont.



Usage examples: Online communications - Collaboration ads cont.



Usage examples: Online communications - Website

For the website logo placement is critical to retain the visual strength of the brand. For this reason the logo will be in a floating box that hovers on the bottom right side of the site at all times. This speaks to the unconventional nature of the brand and emphasizes the concept of signing our work.

The logo will be locked to the top right corner and will stay on the page throughout all the scrolling - persistent

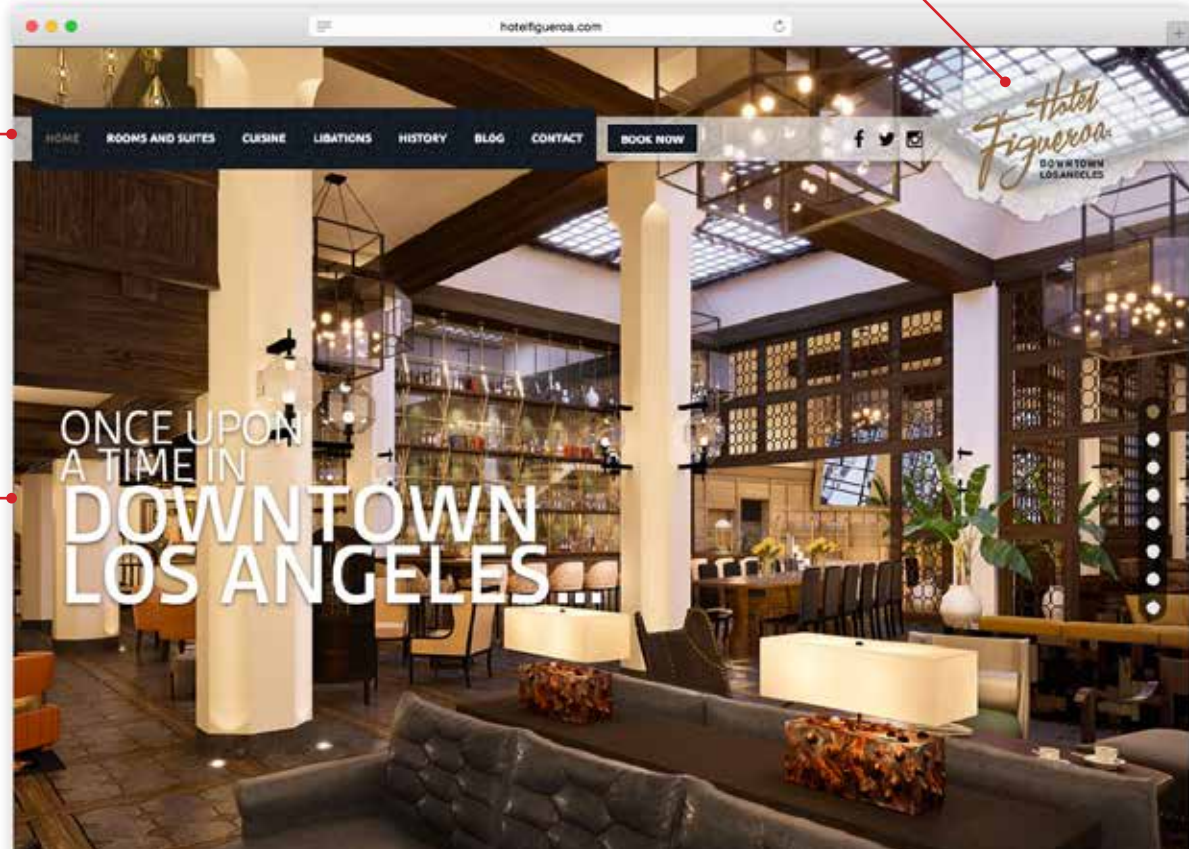
This is the primary header for the site.

The MENU “pop-out” will have direct links to internal pages.

Book Now - leads to the booking page.

Social Icons

Image scroller and story teller



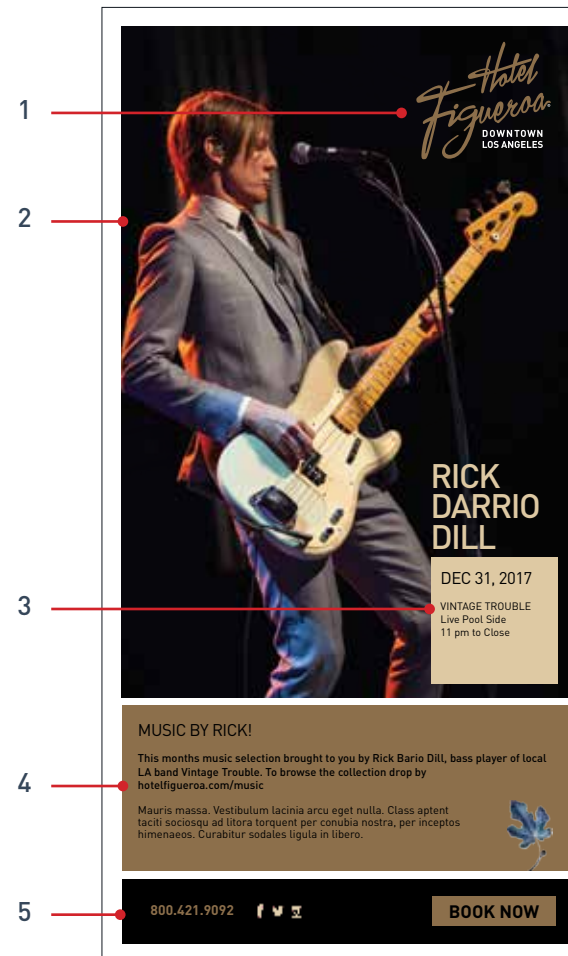
Usage examples: Online communications - Email templates

Our emails will follow one of three formats, a single topic email (which is preferable for most events and announcements), a three image format that tells a visual story, and a newsletter format which will be a regularly scheduled send.

Single image

These examples have five fundamental components.

1. Logo in top right corner in appropriate color
2. Single "Hero" image
3. Name of artist and event details
4. Block of informative copy
5. Book Now footer bar



Usage examples: Online communications - Email templates

Three image

These examples have five fundamental components.

1. Logo in top right corner in appropriate color
2. Three story telling images
3. Name of artist and event details
4. Isolated interest image
5. Block of informative copy
6. Book Now footer bar



Usage examples: Online communications - Email templates

Newsletter

These examples have five fundamental components.

1. Logo in top right corner in appropriate color
2. Three story telling images
3. Event info boxes (Calendar)
4. Isolated interest image
5. Block of informative copy
6. Book Now footer bar



Usage examples: Trade show graphics

When creating trade show graphics, consider the location of where the banner will be displayed. For standing banners that are at eye level and for an event, for example, copy can be added.

If the banner is to hang from a ceiling then no copy should be used and the banner should be considered a brand and image banner only. Logo should be placed at the bottom of the banner.



Standing banner

The primary logo should be placed as close to eye level as possible



Hanging banner

The primary logo should be placed at the bottom of the banner and isolated as much as possible to increase visibility



Usage examples: Incorrect use

Hopefully following the rules will keep everything consistent, but just in case here are some things we never do for reference.

1.



2.



3.



4.



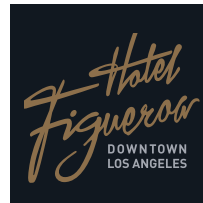
5.



6.



7.



8.



DONT'S

1. Don't move "Downtown Los Angeles".
2. Don't remove "Downtown Los Angeles".
3. Don't apply any effects.
4. Don't rotate the logo.
5. Don't skew or attempt to make the logo 3-dimensional in any way.
6. Don't make a pattern or texture out of the logo.
7. Don't alter the transparency of the logo.
8. Don't recolor the logo unless it is a color within the recommended spec.

Not shown

- NEVER remove the registration mark.
- Don't combine the logo with any other elements— such as logos, words, graphics, photos, slogans or symbols that might seem to create a hybrid mark.
- Don't display the logo in a way that suggests that a third party's logo is more important or primary to the Hotel Figueroa Logo.

VISUAL IDENTITY



Color

Our palette is based on the rich, deep colors of our interior design.

In this section we will show how these colors should be represented in multiple mediums from print, web, and photography.

The Color System

The Hotel Figueroa palette is a combination of rich colors and textures that may be combined a variety of ways.

Both the Color Wheel and Pantone Color blocks are designed to be a guide when deciding on color combinations in both photographic and design executions.

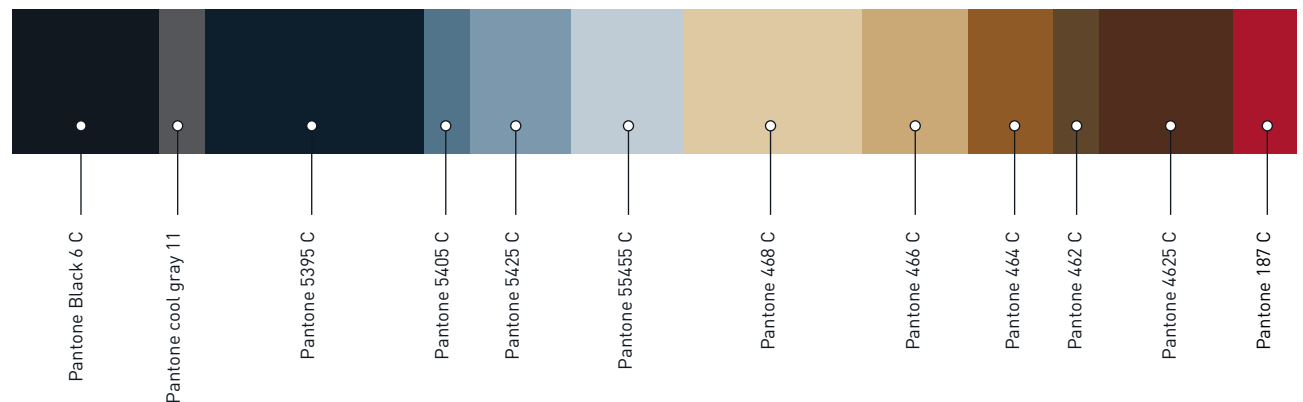
How is this used?

When selecting clothing for a lifestyle shoot, selecting lighting, or designing advertising materials these colors should be used as a guide in deciding, not only the primary focal point colors, but also the surrounding location or design elements.

Color wheel showing recommended color balance



Pantone blocks showing recommended color balance



Pantone Color Boxes



Color: Specifications

The Color System palettes

Both the cool and warm palettes are designed to work in concert to create rich, engaging art and imagery.

Metals

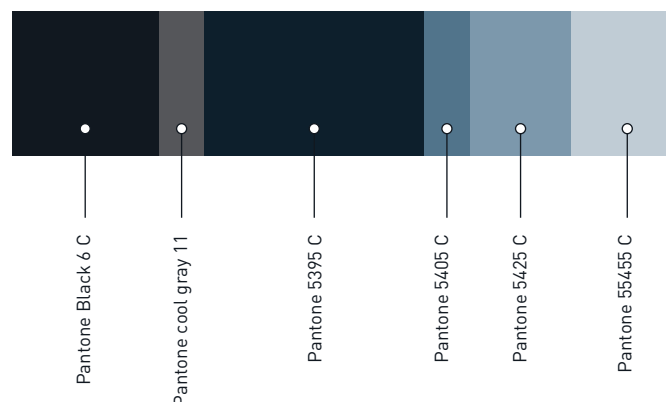
For executions such as hotel collateral, clothing and promotional materials metal inks add a layer of elegance and texture to the final work.

Signature and Initials Logos

Metallic Pantone 874 C + Pantone Black 6 C are used for both the Signature and Initials versions of the logos when used in printed materials.



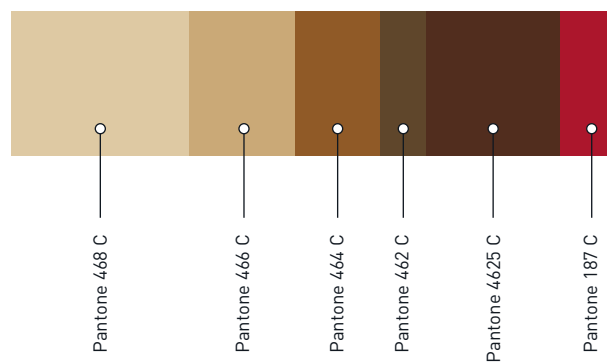
Cool palette



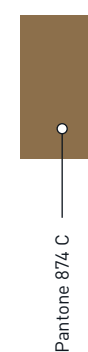
Cool metal palette



Warm palette



Warm metal palette



Color: Specifications, cont.

Pantone colors and metallics should be used whenever possible. For printed media and screening this may not be an option. In those instances the color sets below are provided to produce the closest match.

Primary Color Pallet - Cool

PANTONE BLACK 6 C			
C: 81	R: 17		
M: 71	G: 24		
Y: 59	B: 32		
K: 76			
HEX: #10181F			

COOL GRAY 11			
C: 65	R: 85		
M: 57	G: 86		
Y: 52	B: 90		
K: 29			
HEX: #555659			

PANTONE 5395 C			
C: 89	R: 13		
M: 73	G: 31		
Y: 56	B: 44		
K: 67			
HEX: #0d1f2b			

PANTONE 5405 C			
C: 73	R: 81		
M: 47	G: 116		
Y: 33	B: 139		
K: 7			
HEX: #51748b			

PANTONE 5425 C			
C: 55	R: 124		
M: 33	G: 152		
Y: 24	B: 172		
K: 0			
HEX: #7c97ab			

PANTONE 5455 C			
C: 24	R: 192		
M: 13	G: 204		
Y: 11	B: 213		
K: 0			
HEX: #c0ccd4			

Cool metal

PANTONE 8483 C

Secondary Color Pallet - Warm

PANTONE 187 C			
C: 22	R: 172		
M: 100	G: 22		
Y: 89	B: 44		
K: 15			
HEX: #ab162b			

PANTONE 4825 C			
C: 44	R: 81		
M: 74	G: 45		
Y: 81	B: 30		
K: 58			
HEX: #512c1d			

PANTONE 462 C			
C: 47	R: 95		
M: 61	G: 70		
Y: 83	B: 43		
K: 44			
HEX: #5f462b			

PANTONE 464 C			
C: 33	R: 144		
M: 64	G: 90		
Y: 97	B: 39		
K: 24			
HEX: #8f5926			

PANTONE 466 C			
C: 22	R: 202		
M: 32	G: 169		
Y: 60	B: 119		
K: 0			
HEX: #caa977			

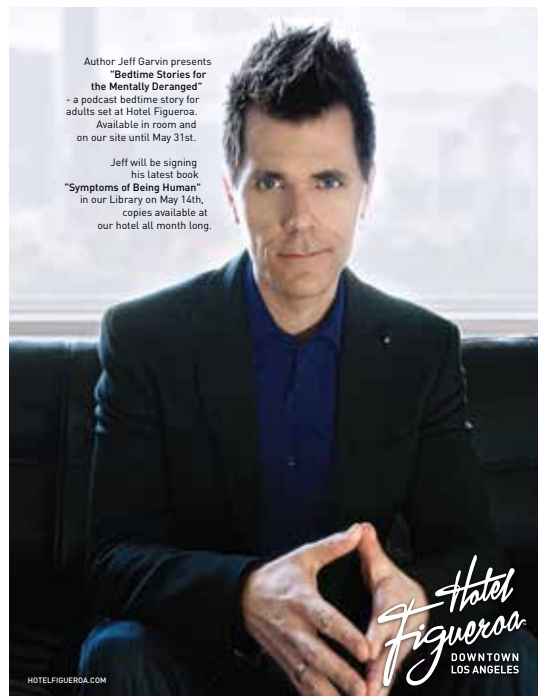
PANTONE 468 C			
C: 13	R: 222		
M: 18	G: 201		
Y: 38	B: 163		
K: 0			
HEX: #ddc9a3			

Warm metal

PANTONE 874 C

Color: In photos

Note how the use of color across multiple images can tie them all together.



Imagery

We are using a three-tiered image system that encompasses the elements we will use to market the property across all mediums. This section will discuss individual and combined use of photography.

Three-tier imagery system:

1. **Collaboration** – these images will feature one of our collaborators either as a headshot or in action. These images convey not only our sense of collaboration, but our humility by putting our artists first.
2. **Work and Play Lifestyle** – these images capture people immersed in creativity. Beyond immersion they also speak to our love of education and our desire to inspire.
3. **Architectural** – our architectural shots should show us as a safe and warm environment and can speak to our history and residential style interior design.

Collaboration



Work and play lifestyle

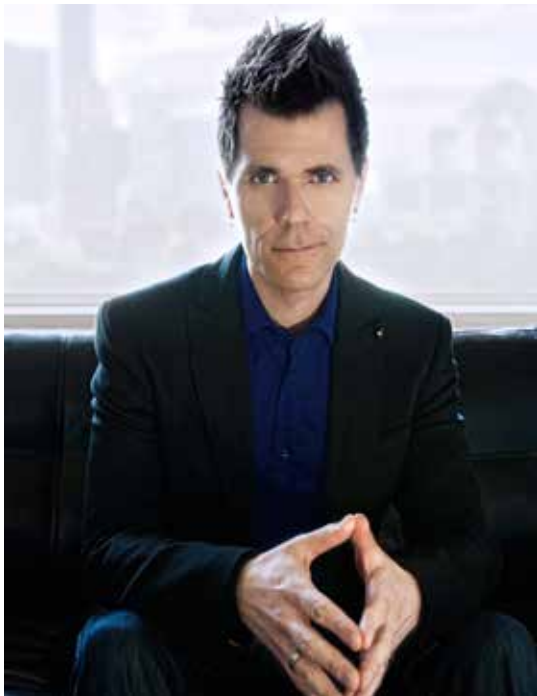


Architectural



Imagery: Collaborators

Our collaborator images are meant to convey the style and personality of the artist. They will be paired with copy that tells the audience about their art, so the job of the image is to make them interesting, to build them up as the artist to our humble canvas. They should embody an almost heroic quality; they are our most interesting person in the world for this moment.



Imagery: Palette

Each shot for the hotel should convey a sense of warmth and engagement, a feeling of being in a moment. Tying the color of each shot to our palette is the first important step in achieving a cohesive sense.



Imagery: Multiple image story telling

When using multiple images together for a single topic communication, make sure to tell a story.

Examples:

A Cooking Event

- Ingredient
- Chef
- Eating

A Music Event

- Instrument
- Player
- Performance

DON'T use three shots of food, a person, or an artist, tell the story of the event with imagery where possible.



Typography: Typefaces

As with our logo, consistent use of our typefaces—Din OT® & Xtream®—reinforce Hotel Figueroa’s brand identity.

Din OT will be used 97% of the time as Xtream is more of an art element.

Primary typeface - Din OT

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
01234567890
~!@#\$%^&*() +[]{}|:; ‘ ’ < > ? , . /

Din OT Regular:should be used for all body copy
Din OT Medium: should be used for headlines
Din OT Bold: **should be used for emphasis within copy blocks but not as a headline font.**

Short headlines or labels can be all caps, otherwise headlines and subheads are sentence case.

Din OT Bold is used for Downtown Los Angeles in the logo.

Avoid condensed or extended type.

Din Regular	The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog
Din Italic	<i>The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog</i>
Din Medium	The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog
Din Medium Italic	<i>The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog</i>
Din Bold	The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog
Din Bold Italic	<i>The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog</i>

Secondary type face - Xtream

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
01234567890
~!@^() [] \ {} ' , /

Xtream Thin: should be used for large placements
Xtream Medium: should be used for call outs (primary)
Xtream Bold: should be used over images for clarity

Primary use for Xtream is as a title or end tag for copy blocks to add a level of personalization and graphic design. This font should not be used under 12 point.

<i>Din Light</i>	<i>The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog</i>
<i>Din Light</i>	<i>The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog</i>
<i>Din Light</i>	<i>The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog</i>

Typography: Typeface sizing

When using Din, auto or metric kerning is recommended.
Use these guidelines for tracking at various sizes.

4 point: tracked +20

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog.

5 point: tracked +16

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog.

6 point: tracked +12

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog.

7 point: tracked +8

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog.

8 point: tracked +4

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog.

9 point: tracked 0

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog.

10 point: tracked 0

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog.

11 point: tracked 0

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog.

12 point: tracked 0

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog.

14 point: tracked -3

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog.

Typography: Typeface sizing cont.

16 point: tracked -4

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog.

20 point: tracked -5

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog.

24 point: tracked -6

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog.

30 point: tracked -8

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog.

36 point: tracked -8

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog.

Typography: Trademark symbols

It is important that the size of the trademark symbol be in proportion with the text. The trademark symbol should always be legible without being intrusive and the space between the trademark symbol and the preceding letter should be minimized.

Din Font

When using Din at any size, the trademark symbols should be approximately 1/3 the size of the primary font, with a baseline shift that aligns the ® to the top of the previous letter. Depending on the size, it may technically align or sit slightly above but never below.

Hotel Figueroa®

Hotel Figueroa®

Hotel Figueroa®

Xtreem

As previously shown, Xtreem is only to be used as an accent to a Din copy block.

Sample

In the sample below the “Coming Soon” is written in Xtreem and made into art that caps off the copy block adding a call-to-action.



Graphics: Fig Leaf and Pattern

The Blue Fig Leaf

Inspired by the interior design team; this blue fig leaf is a visual icon that can be used in many situations to add a visual stamp to any communication piece. It should be used to add color and interest.

The Blue Fig Leaf Pattern

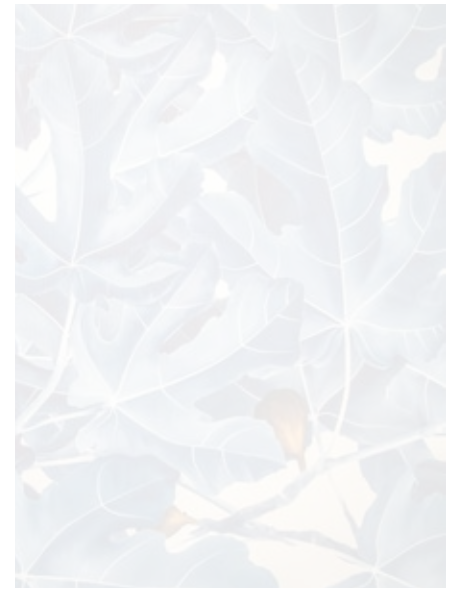
This pattern can be found within the rooms of the hotel. If it is used on any printed or digital communications it should either be used to add color and texture where the primary design is white. Most common use will be on collateral materials for the hotel.

This can be used in a number of ways

- As a thin strip
- Screened back to 10% or less
- As a color wall
- On the reverse of solids, menus, letterhead, business cards, etc.



Used best floating over clear space as an accent



Used best screened to 10% as a background texture



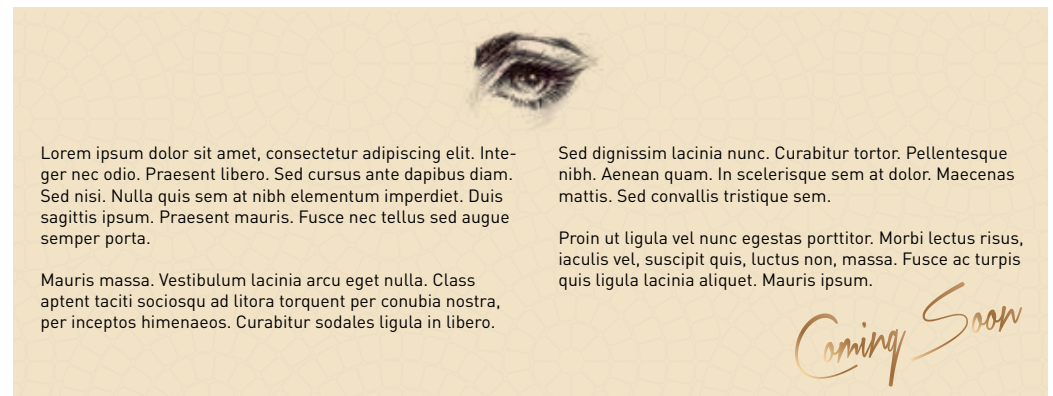
Full color strip

Graphics: Icons

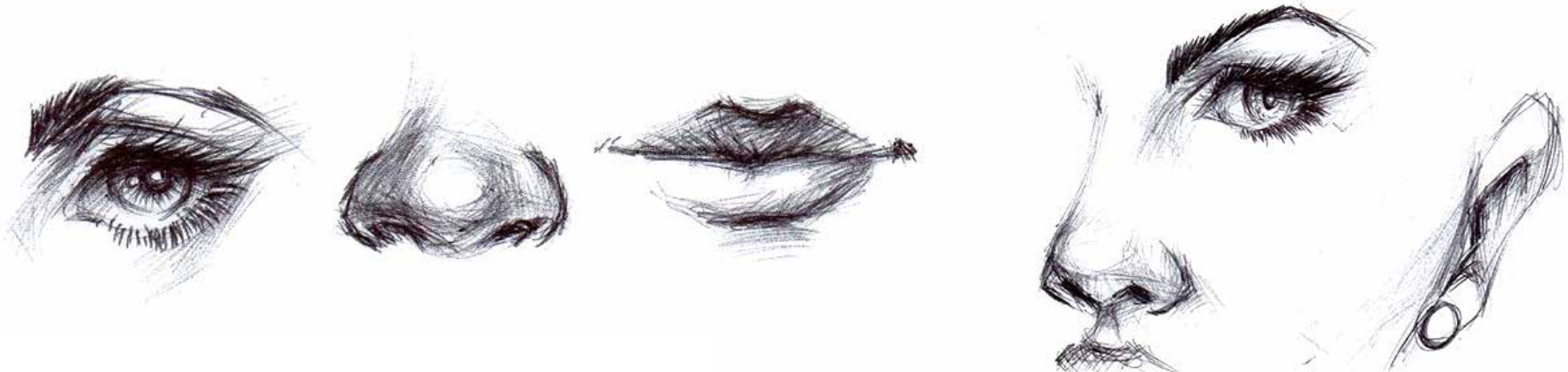
Illustrations

This style of imagery is used to add a vintage feel to the piece and is best used as a compliment to the work where stylistically appropriate.

Throughout the creative executions of the property it is recommended we bring in illustrated work as in the example of these sensory images.



In this example the "Eye" icon relates to the "Coming Soon" copy, hinting at something new to see.



BRANDED MERCHANDISE

Merchandise: Usage examples

Our branded merchandise is a visual embodiment of our hotel that travels to the far reaches of the globe.

For this reason the pieces should be representative of our brand and our brand aesthetic. There will be many materials created over time but these examples show the consistency and quality that we should adhered to.

1. Signature T-Shirts

These are for sales and promotional purposes and are the primary T-Shirts that would be sold and given away as gifts. These would be printed with a metallic ink where possible. Colors can vary

2. DTLA T-Shirts

These are primarily for promotional purposes and for DTLA events

3. Caps

These are custom caps designed to promote the hotel and can be sold or given as gift

4. Collared Shirts

These are for sales and promotional purposes and are the primary Collared Shirts that would be sold and given away as gifts. These would be embroidered with a metallic thread

5. Sporting Event Jersey

Rather than support one of LA's major sport teams in our neighborhood we would like to see Hotel Figueroa Fans wearing our stuff and supporting all DTLA teams.

1.



2.



3.



4.



5.



Merchandise: Usage examples, cont.

1. Satchel
2. Cardigan
3. Bag
4. Coffee Cups
5. Flash Drive
6. Pens
7. Golf Balls

1.



2.



3.



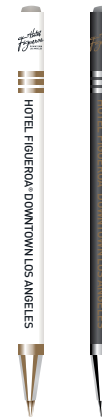
4.



5.



6.



7.



COLLATERAL

Collateral: Stationary

Our internal collateral conveys our brand to guests and corporate partners.

It should represent our brand and be of high quality in both design and production with a special focus to the inks, paper, and metal foils used.

1. Business Cards

Printed on master sheets, these 2-sided cards will feature full color printing, metallic ink and spot varnish to convey a sense of professionalism and artist flair. They make a statement to our commitment to quality and creativity.

2. Letterhead

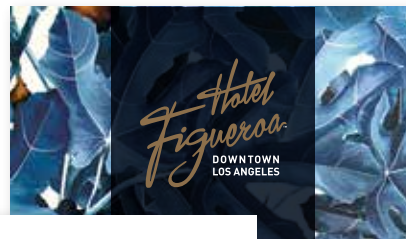
There will be multiple versions of our letterhead.

- Brand: 2-sided, full color
- Standard: Single sided, metallic, embossed logo
- General: Single sided, one color

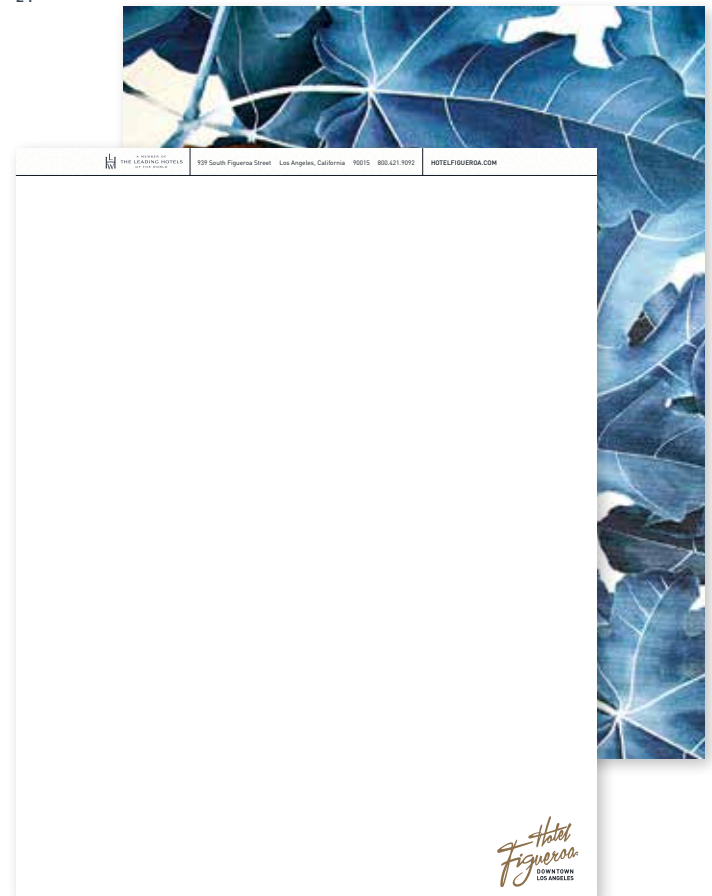
3. Envelope

These envelopes have a unique feature in that they are printed on both the outside and inside, providing a unique look to the piece and adding a touch of artist flair that, once again, speaks to the fundamentals of our brand. To relate to artists, we must be artists.

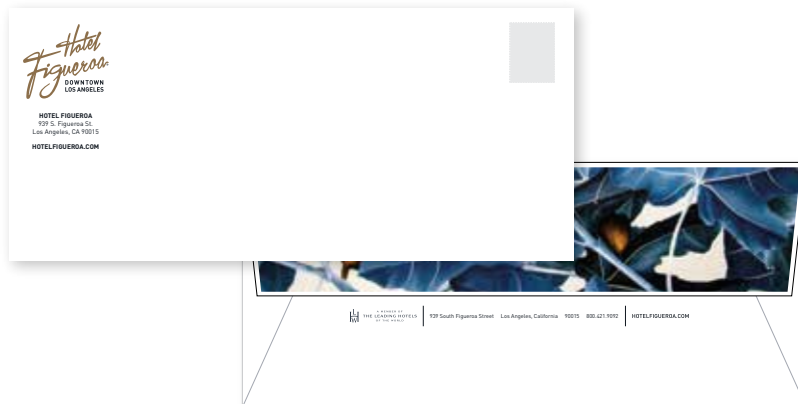
1.



2.



3.



Collateral: Artifacts

1. Binder
2. Lanyard
3. Leather bowl
4. Folder
5. Keycard Holder

1.



2.



3.



4.



5.

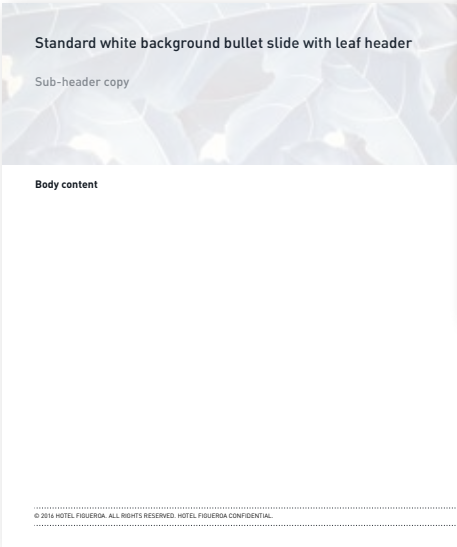


Collateral: Presentation templates

The templates are available in both standard and wide-screen formats, and in both PowerPoint® and Keynote®.



Title slide



Body slide



Closing slide

Collateral: E-mail signatures

Aside from editing the contact information, do not alter the layout in any way, including adding/changing colors, changing the font, etc.

Primary desktop email signature



EMPLOYEE NAME	T: 000.000.0000	939 S. Figueroa St.
Title (i.e. General Manager)	F: 000.000.0000	Los Angeles, CA 90015
Department (i.e. Sales)	R: 000.000.0000	
	yourname@hotelfigueroa.com	HOTELFIGUEROA.COM

Optional one-line signature for replies/forwards

EMPLOYEE NAME | Title (i.e. General Manager) | Hotel Figueroa | T: 213.627.8971 | name@hotelfigueroa.com

Primary mobile email signature

EMPLOYEE NAME
Title (i.e. General Manager)
Department (i.e. Sales)



T: 000.000.0000
F: 000.000.0000
R: 000.000.0000

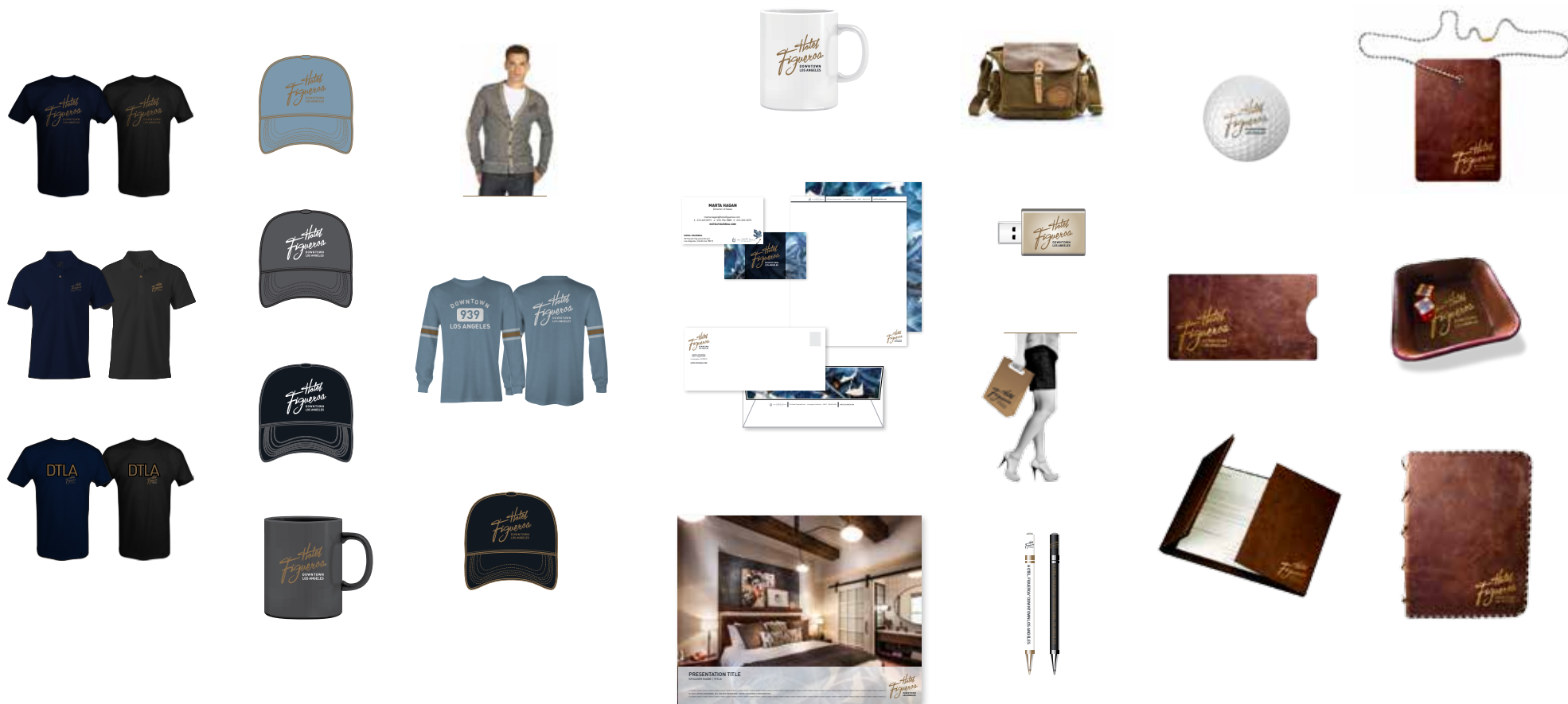
yourname@hotelfigueroa.com

939 S. Figueroa St.
Los Angeles, CA 90015

HOTELFIGUEROA.COM

Collection

Together our merchandise and collateral should represent our palette and be an extension of our brand, both within the rooms and off property.





LEGAL GUIDELINES



Hotel name

Primary use (for use on all external and internal signage)

Hotel Figueroa® Downtown Los Angeles (in all instances possible this will be the Signature logo)

Secondary: (for all legal references):

Hotel Figueroa®

Incorrect:

Figueroa Hotel

Fig

The Fig

Hotel Fig

Figueroa Downtown Los Angeles

Hotel Figueroa Downtown LA

Copyright notice & attribution statements

Please include a copyright notice and an attribution statement, which may appear in small, but still legible, print, when using any Hotel Figueroa trademarks in any published materials.

The format for Hotel Figueroa's copyright notice is as follows:

© [Year of Publication] Hotel Figueroa. All rights reserved.

The format for the attribution statement should be:

List of Hotel Figueroa marks used, beginning with “Hotel Figueroa” and “the Hotel Figueroa logos,” if used, followed by any other marks (in alphabetical order) “are either registered trademarks or trademarks of Hotel Figueroa Incorporated in the United States and/or other countries.”

For example:

Hotel Figueroa, the Hotel Figueroa Signature logo, and the Hotel Figueroa Initials logo are either registered trademarks or trademarks of Hotel Figueroa in the United States and/or other countries.

The attribution statement typically is included with other legal lines, such as the copyright notice, at the end of a document or on the copyright page of a book or manual.

EDITORIAL VOICE



Overview

Editorial/Web Tone of Voice:

A Tone of Voice is not what we say, but how we say it. This encompasses the words we choose, their order, rhythm and pace. Our tone of voice will inform all of its written copy, including its website, social media messages, emails and packaging.

At our core, Hotel Figueroa is a safe and welcoming environment for creative minds in Downtown Los Angeles. Our brand pillars and values are designed to support this point and should be present in our voice.



Voice: Values

Editorial/Web Tone of Voice:

We are sincere, but playful enough not to take ourselves too seriously

We are excited about life and share that excitement

We are competent and highly effective

We are sophisticated, glamorous and charming, but never pretentious

We are creative collaborators always open to inviting participation

We are caring and sharing with our planet and all of its inhabitants

We are authentic Los Angeles, not contrived

Voice: Formality

The formality of our tone will often be fluid and conversational. For example, we want to greet guests politely in person, but then show genuine interest, which may be considered a little less formal. So greeting a guest we might say, “Good Afternoon, welcome to the Hotel Figueroa. Are you having a wonderful day in downtown Los Angeles?”—and then actually wait for an answer and respond to what our guest says. In other words, invite a conversation like you would, you know, as people. In table service, front desk and management we should maintain a bit more formality, as we are a luxury brand. However, social media posts or blogs may begin with something more conversational like, “**What’s up Figueroa Faithful?**” Our guideline for formality will be to stay humble at all times, putting the people who make up our organization—from guests to staff and artisans—before our organization itself. We strive to constantly recognize and appreciate others for what they bring to Downtown Los Angeles and the Hotel Figueroa.

A note on language: we should refrain from exceedingly foul language, yet never be above comical insinuation. In fact, we should never be “above” most things, as that can sometimes come across as pretentious. So it’s more than okay to be cheeky, but never filthy. We are flirtatious, fun and even sexy and provocative. We can be sarcastic, but never at the expense of a person because we want to remain a wholly positive brand.



Voice: Colloquialisms and Slang

Slang and Colloquialisms are fine in ads, web or other copy. We should avoid directly millennial concepts, as our target demographic is older than that age group. So stay away from whipping and nae nae's and anything else that may actively exclude people. With our history and longevity as a hotel, we can throw in both new and dated slang. So our audience may be “fam,” “our people,” or “cats” depending on the overall tone of the piece.

Voice: Pronoun usage

We should assign ownership to positive things (i.e. aspects of a guest's stay they're looking forward to) with pronouns wherever possible. For example: "This week at your Hotel Figueroa" or "Book Your Suite Online."

Make sure to order pronouns in a proactive manner.

For example, in this sentence you'll notice that we are reacting to a need:

"You may want to see the sites in downtown LA while you visit, so we set up a variety of city tours for you to enjoy."

The proactive version of that would look like:

"We offer a variety of tours in case you want to take in the sites of downtown LA on your visit."

Notice how we address a need in the event that it arises, as opposed to creating a need and then immediately answering it. The latter communicates our brand more effectively to guests.

When addressing something that is expected or may not be the most fun (like parking), don't use the pronoun at all.

Instead of:

"At Hotel Figueroa, you won't have to worry about parking....";

we say,

"At Hotel Figueroa there's no need to worry about parking..."

Take the guest out of the problem entirely, and even pre-empt the problem itself. So we assure them it's not even a problem, but do it in a way where we're not ordering our guest around and giving them something to worry about as in the first example.



Voice: Grammar

The key to being a smart brand is also sounding intelligent when we communicate. From contractions to commas, we really can't screw up the basics. However, we should avoid pretense and give ourselves leeway when needed.

We believe you have to know the rules to break them. For example, we may use “whom” if it suits the mood of the sentence, but “who” is also fine. And if we want to make a statement by intentionally using bad grammar, like anything as cool as “We don't need no education,” then we should. The general rule is stick to MLA grammar—and if you intend to break the rules, do it obviously and on purpose.

Voice: Context and Convention

While we are about occasionally bad grammar, some cussing and a whole lot of slang, we should avoid talking “Twitter” outside of our actual Twitter account. Avoid LOL’ing ROFL’ing, being OMW or any other social abbreviations. This type of shorthand is just not our brand. We want to communicate clearly in all things, and if anything ever does make us roll on the floor with laughter we can take the time to type that phrase out in return.

Guides for Writing Figueroa

1. **Tap into a Feeling.** “What’s up Figueroa Faithful???” “You’re not going to believe what we’re serving for dinner tonight” “Do I have the inside scoop for you!” Get the reader going right away with a headline or opening line.
2. **Be Humble.** Can’t say it enough: we are not an arrogant brand.
3. **Commit to humor.** It’s definitely not all jokes, but we can be lighthearted and funny in all things.
4. **Be Gentle.** All people don’t love all things, so we don’t make everything the greatest or best ever. Share with them what we find cool about a thing and move on without selling too hard.
5. **Be Different.** We are welcoming instead of too cool. We introduce art like an excited child full of wonder, not like a snotty gallery owner. We like to be a bit outrageous or odd—and invite others to jump in with us.
6. **Be Unusual.** Everyone celebrates Thanksgiving, for example. But let’s make sure to also celebrate the rest—like 5pm, or Mondays, or other things in which we can find the everyday amazing.
7. **Be Bold.** Never let being humble and gentle to our artists and guests take away from being BOLD. Be passionate about DTLA, about our artists and about what we stand for as a brand.



Voice: Tell a Story

It is always important to remember our role as storytellers. We can't be all facts; we have to make it interesting. So whether we are writing our "About" section on our site, a sales deck or an ad, we should always tell a story. That bears repeating: **we should always tell a story**. But how do we make sure we're telling a good story?

A good story must:

- Be about a specific person, or a small group of people, rather than about a whole company
- Draw out a basic human emotion such as hope or excitement
- Feature struggle and require the character to change or learn something
- Embrace the little details that set this story apart from the next.

A story must feature a series of challenges or obstacles that lie in the path of the protagonist and whatever he or she is trying to achieve.

Our stories at Hotel Figueroa can draw from a variety of sources such as:

History: We have a rich, storied and well-documented history that's perfect storytelling fodder.

Daily occurrences or events: Our marketing model dictates that we should provide a regular stream of current and future event stories.

How we do things differently: From being DTLA ambassadors to charitable giving, our hotel is striving to be different than our competition. These stories should always avoid being self-serving—and also promise to be some of our strongest.



FOR MORE INFORMATION

Governance

Agency689 is responsible for governance of this style guide through launch. All brand communications must be sent to them for approval. Once PR is engaged, their team will take over editorial copy approvals. All advertising and marketing approvals will continue to remain with Agency689.

All use of Hotel Figueroa assets must be sent for approval to: info@agency689.com

For questions, please e-mail: info@agency689.com



*Hotel
Figueroa*[™]
DOWNTOWN
LOS ANGELES